



Blurring the lines between proprietary and open

Android may be based on Linux, but it's not based on the type of Linux system you may have used on your PC. You can't run Android apps on a typical Linux distributions and you can't run the Linux programs you're familiar with on Android. While Linux does make up the core of Android, Google hasn't added all the typical software and libraries you'd find on a Linux distribution like Ubuntu.

ChromeOS is to Linux what OS X is to BSD. In other words, it's a forked operating system that uses the Linux kernel under the hood. Much of the operating system is made up of Google's own proprietary blend of code and software. So while ChromeOS is using the Linux kernel under its hood, it's still very different from what we might find with today's modern Linux distributions. Where ChromeOS's difference becomes most apparent, however, is in the apps it offers the end user: Web applications. Exclusively. With everything being launched from a browser window, Linux users might find using ChromeOS to be a bit vanilla. But for non-Linux users, the experience is not all that different than what they may have on their old PCs. Anyone who is living a Google-centric lifestyle on Windows will feel right at home on ChromeOS. Odds are this guy is already relying on the Chrome browser, Google Drive and Gmail almost exclusively.